Build Before You Buy

The Business Case for Internal Mobility

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19	15.2	$35.3K
proposed transfers	expected successes	net audit advantage

A skills inventory can make internal capability visible without making it deployable. I wanted to know when improving that visibility is worth paying for after the organisation accounts for consent, verified evidence, manager release, transition delay and backfill. The decision is an internal-mobility investment, not simply a headcount substitution.

Primary finding

Expected cost, CAD; all external versus matched scenarios



CAD 45,300 gross audit advantage; CAD 35,300 after programme cost

Under the default assumptions, the evidence audit retains CAD 35,300 of modeled advantage after a CAD 10,000 programme cost. Increasing that cost to CAD 50,000 changes the advantage to negative CAD 4,700. The financial case therefore depends on a bounded audit cost and on the transfer-success and release assumptions holding in practice.

Evidence status: all operational data and financial assumptions are synthetic. The figures below are model/fixture results, not client outcomes.

From an HR decision to a defensible metric

The workforce-planning sponsor must fill 31 seats across eight disjoint skill pools in Ontario and B.C. The synthetic evidence base contains 240 profiles. A distinction between qualifications and occupational use is relevant in Canada, but this model does not infer immigration status, credentials or protected characteristics for employees.

01 / Feasible supply
An employee enters eligible supply only when consent, manager release and verified evidence are present. Each employee has one primary skill pool, preventing duplicated capacity across roles.

02 / Option enumeration
For each pool, enumerate ready and bridge transfers within demand, available supply and release limits. Ready transfers consume CAD 1,000 of development budget; bridge transfers consume CAD 4,500.

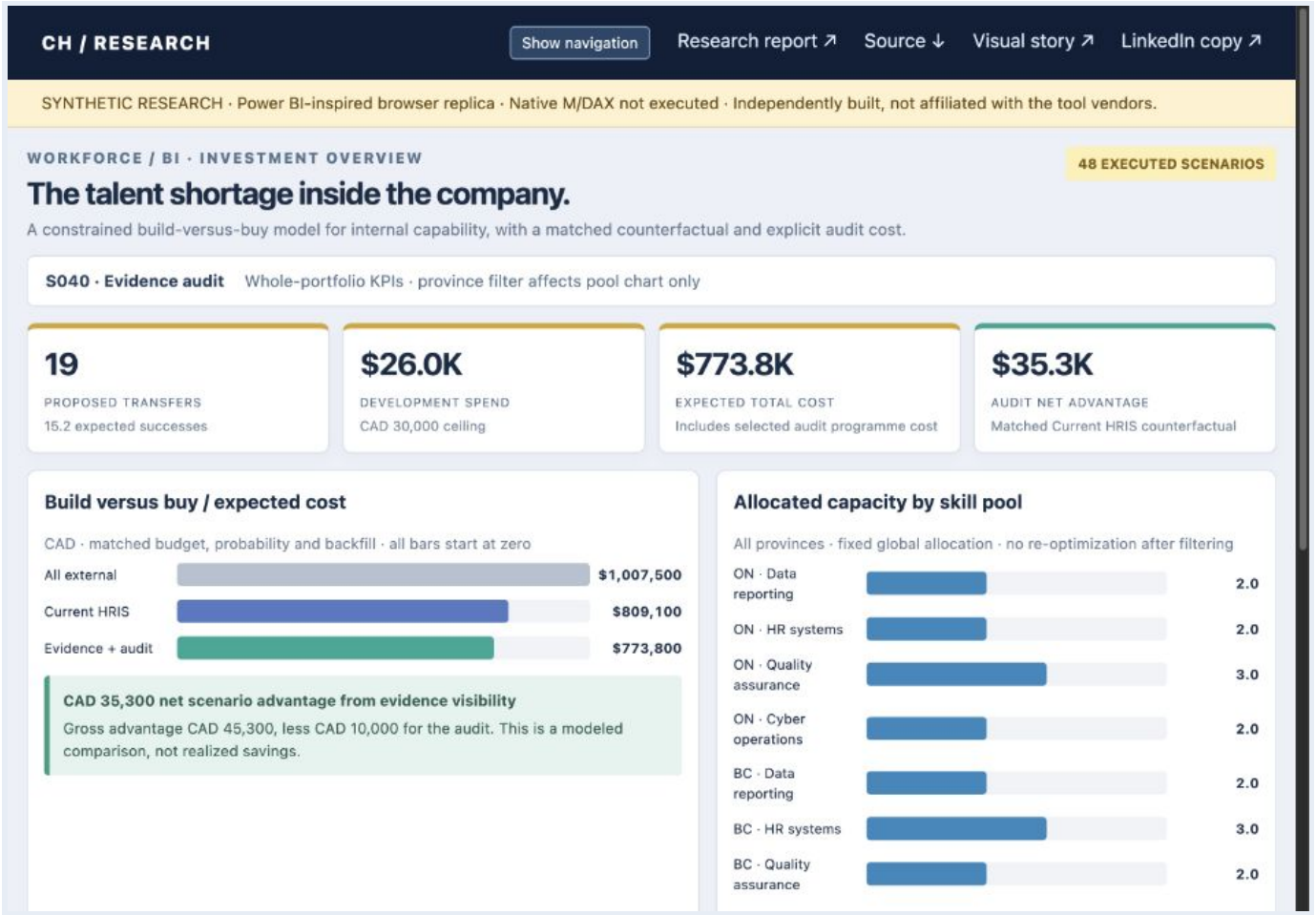
03 / Portfolio optimisation
Dynamic programming selects from finite pool options under one shared development budget. Costs include backfill, transition delay, uncovered seats and external fallback when an internal transfer fails.

04 / Matched counterfactual
Compare Evidence audit with Current HRIS at the same budget, success probability and backfill rate. Deduct audit programme cost once at portfolio level. Province filtering is descriptive; it does not solve the allocation again.

Metric / construct	Definition / interpretation
Proposed transfers	Ready plus bridge allocations; not completed moves
Expected success	Proposals × transfer-success probability
Budget used	Development spend; excludes backfill and audit cost
Expected total cost	Allocation cost + applicable audit programme cost
Net audit advantage	Matched HRIS cost minus evidence cost minus audit

Reproducibility: the independent project package contains source, frozen synthetic inputs, a verification entry point, dashboard data and the report. Run **python3 verify.py** from the project root.

Management view: the audit has to earn its cost



01 / Scenario context

Visibility, budget, success probability and backfill select one executed scenario. Audit cost adjusts the comparison without changing the pool allocation.

02 / Matched comparison

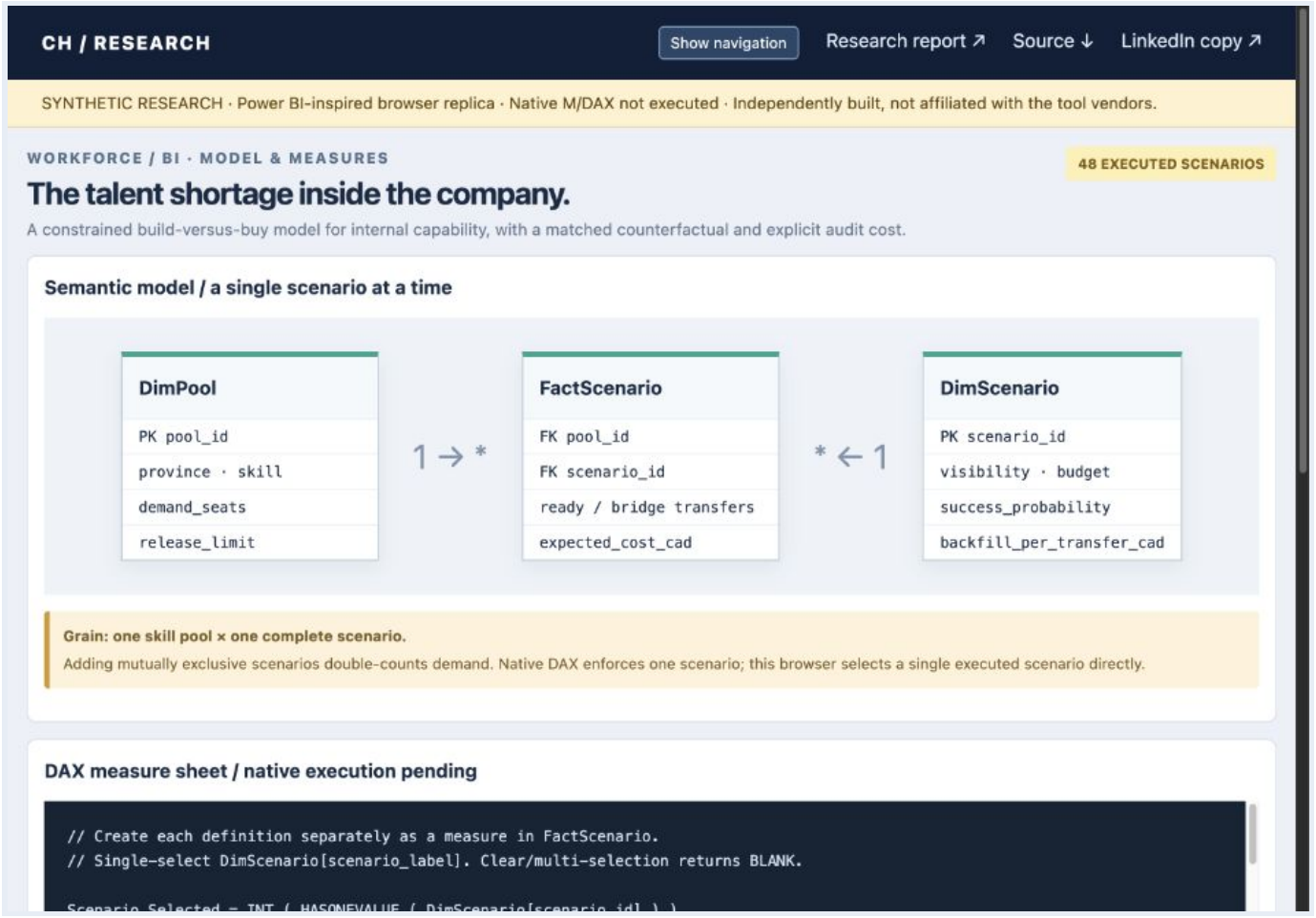
The all-external benchmark is useful context. The audit question is answered against matched Current HRIS, not against that larger benchmark.

03 / Capacity discipline

The pool chart shows proposed moves within a global allocation. Province filtering does not release a second budget.

Figure 1. Actual viewport capture of the working browser implementation. The scrollable dashboard contains the full charts, grids and source panes. Tool resemblance is a presentation convention; native execution is not implied. Full-size images and captions are in the screenshot gallery.

Technical view: one scenario, one coherent denominator



01 / Semantic model

DimPool and DimScenario join to FactScenario. The fact grain is one pool by one complete scenario, with 384 rows across 48 alternatives.

02 / DAX contract

Scenario-safe measures guard against summing mutually exclusive alternatives. The report includes source M and DAX for a future native build.

03 / Tool provenance

This functional browser replica uses executed Python scenario facts. It is not a PBIX export and does not demonstrate native DAX execution.

Figure 2. Actual viewport capture of the working browser implementation. The scrollable dashboard contains the full charts, grids and source panes. Tool resemblance is a presentation convention; native execution is not implied. Full-size images and captions are in the screenshot gallery.

What the evidence supports

Default scenario item	Value	Interpretation
Ready / bridge proposals	17 / 2	19 total
Development spend	CAD 26,000	CAD 30,000 ceiling
Expected successes	15.2	80% × 19
Pre-audit evidence cost	CAD 763,800	Includes transfer fallback
Audit break-even ceiling	CAD 45,300	Matched gross advantage

Validation and execution provenance

Evidence check	Result / boundary
Scenario reproduction	48 scenarios / 384 pool rows reproduce
Capacity constraints	Demand, supply and release bounds hold
Shared budget	Every scenario stays within its ceiling
High audit-cost sensitivity	CAD 50,000 produces -CAD 4,700 net
Native Power BI	M/DAX provided; native execution pending

Limits of inference. The result is exact only for the finite modeled option set. Pools are disjoint; multi-skilled employees and network effects are not optimised. Financial inputs, consent and release behaviour are invented. Transfer success is a scenario parameter, not an estimated probability. Employee retention, equity of opportunity and disruption to source teams require independent evaluation. Expected cost avoidance is not realised savings.

Recommended next study. Pilot the evidence audit in a bounded capability area. Validate transfer success, development cost and release commitments with both source and receiving managers. Compare observed outcomes with the same external-hiring counterfactual and keep programme cost below a revised, evidence-based break-even ceiling.

Sources and research basis

Statistics Canada: education-occupation mismatch

Microsoft: SELECTEDVALUE reference

Microsoft: Power BI HR sample tour

Public sources establish context or method; they do not supply the simulated microdata. Ontario indexed official text was rechecked on 20 October 2026; the other sources were reviewed for the original research baseline. Full provenance is in SOURCES.md.